Even Step

The recommended December 2026 CEA link, in ten minutes

For managers · 26 weeks · code ES-26-T5 · the full proposal sheet has the detail

The short version

Four numbers

9 of 9	35h	0	26
December staffing rules met	**contracted hours a week**	**avoidable fatigue warnings**	**people on the link**
today 4 of 9	Mon–Sat average	cover weeks aside	today 20

Every December staffing rule met — and no shift over 8h 30m, Monday to Saturday.

The staffing you asked for

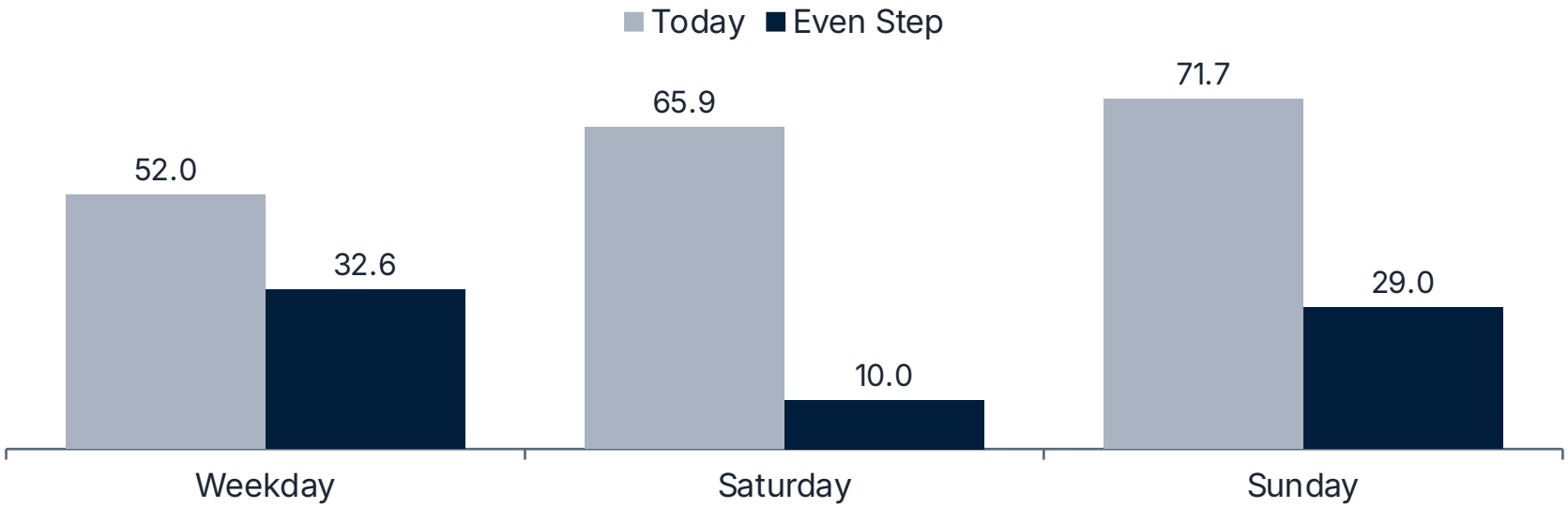
Each figure reads weekday · Saturday · Sunday

	Today	Even Step
On duty each day (Sunday: at least 10)	11–12 · 10 · 8	**15 · 14 · 10**
At the open, at least 4 (06:20, Sun 07:15)	4 · 4 · 3	**5 · 5 · 4**
Still on duty at 22:00, at least 5	4 · 2 · 3	**7 · 5 · 5**
Through to the close, at least 3	2 · 2 · 3	**3 · 3 · 3**
Fewest on the floor at any time, at least 2	2 · 2 · 2	**3 · 3 · 3**

Every level met on every day — and the ticket office staffed in pairs, including Sundays.

People where the trains are

Fit to the trains: floor staff against the December trains, hour by hour — lower is better



Staffing follows the December trains more closely every day — far more at weekends.

People and hours

What it takes to run

	Today	Even Step
People on the link	20	**26**
Contracted hours a week	35h	**35h**
Cover weeks (for leave and sickness)	4 of 20 (20%)	**5 of 26 (19%)**
People needed each Sunday (overtime)	8	**10**

Six more people, the same 35-hour week — and Sundays are still worked as overtime.

Fatigue checks

Office of Rail and Road and rail-industry good practice — not a fatigue risk assessment

	Today	Even Step
Avoidable fatigue warnings, cover weeks aside	4 (up to 5)	**0 (up to 1)**
Most days in a row (limit 13)	7 (up to 9)	**5 (up to 7)**
Shortest rest between shifts (limit 12h)	12h 30m	**14h 35m**
Longest shift, any day	9h 10m	**9h 00m**

Rest and days-in-a-row limits met with room to spare. In brackets: the worst case, if a cover week falls badly.

Why Even Step?

What all three shortlisted links give, what this one adds, and what it costs

- ✓ All three: all 9 December rules; no avoidable fatigue warning, cover weeks aside
- ✓ All three: 14 full weekends off a year each (today 10), at most 5 weeks apart
- ✓ All three: no shift over 9 hours, and every closing shift shorter
- ✓ This one adds: no shift over 8h 30m and every early one of today’s times, Mon–Sat
- ✓ Shift times: 13 (today 18), 8 of them worked today
- – This one costs: lates near today’s 8h 30m, and a slightly weaker weekday fit

What all three cost: more late finishes, two more Saturdays a year, a day more leave for four weeks off.

What colleagues will notice

The three biggest gains and costs, per person, cover weeks aside

Likely to welcome

- **More weekends off**
  14 full weekends a year, not 10
- **Fewer days in a row**
  5 at most, not 7
- **Nothing over 8h 30m, Mon–Sat**
  today's longest is 9h 10m

Likely to worry about

- **More late finishes**
  94 a year at 22:00 or later, not 78
- **More leave for four weeks off**
  15 days, not 14
- **Less premium and overtime pay**
  about £250 a year, gross,
  for a full share of Sundays, swaps aside

Expect late finishes and leave first — the colleague presentation answers both.

Where it stands

Three things settled, two decisions left, two points still open

- ✓ **December rules — confirmed verbally**
  Everything here is built on them; worth having in writing before a link is chosen.
- ✓ **26 people on the link — decided**
  Six more than today, with five cover weeks.
- ✓ **Sunday cover — confirmed verbally**
  Ten on a Sunday — Sunday work stays overtime.
- ? **To decide: which link we use**
  After colleagues' views. Not yet seen by the roster office or a union rep.
- ? **Then: who starts on which line**
  Decided after the link is chosen.

Still open: where the 13-day limit is written; how one fatigue check treats a rest day.



The detail

- Every week of the link, day by day
- Staff on duty hour by hour, against the trains
- Every December rule and fatigue check, worked through

All in the eight-page proposal sheet · Even Step · ES-26-T5 · d1921b7a